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‘This bill would be landmark primary care legislation that could provide a model.’

DR. WAYNE ALTMAN, *a family medicine physician who has been pushing for reforms*

Senate passes bill to bolster primary care

Measure would change how doctors are paid; hospitals, insurers balk

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts boasts some of the most coveted physicians in the world, but the state’s system for primary care, the most basic form of medicine, is broken. Roughly one in three residents say they struggle to obtain such care.

The state Senate, hoping to help ease the problems, passed a bill Thursday evening that would force

the health care industry to provide more support for primary care.

The measure would require hospitals, clinicians, and commercial insurers to steadily increase spending on primary care so it eventually represents at least 15 percent of all health care spending in Massachusetts — which would be more than double the current expenditure.

Crucially, they would have to do that without raising overall spend-

ing or insurance premiums.

Currently, only 6.7 percent of health care spending in the state is on primary care. Meanwhile, investment in specialty care such as dermatology, gastroenterology, and oncology has skyrocketed, say proponents of the legislation.

“Massachusetts residents are struggling to find a primary care doctor, waiting months for an appointment, and too often facing high costs when they finally receive care,” said Senate President Karen Spilka, an Ashland Democrat who made passage of the legislation a

top priority.

The measure would also strengthen community health centers, which often treat low-income residents, Spilka said, and bolster the anemic pipeline of new primary care physicians.

But the proposal has provoked skepticism from insurers and hospital systems. Insurers say it would lead to higher premiums and increase overall health care costs despite assurances to the contrary.

“Unfortunately,” said Lora Pellegrini, president of the Massachusetts
PRIMARY CARE, Page A6

SJC blocks proposal to slash income tax

Ruling calls summary on ballot question unfair, ‘significantly misleading’

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts voters will not get to decide an explosive political issue this November after the state’s highest court rejected a ballot initiative that would have cut the state income tax rate to 4 percent because of an error by the state’s attorney general in the wording of the proposal’s summary.

The decision quickly shook Beacon Hill, where business groups have argued the cost of living in Massachusetts has become too expensive for residents and businesses, while Democratic legislative leaders and unions warned the tax reduction, if passed, would spell disaster for public services.

In an 18-page ruling, Supreme Judicial Court Justice Serge Georges Jr. wrote that a constitutionally required summary of the ballot question prepared by Attorney General Andrea Campbell’s office was not “fair” because it did not inform voters that the question, if passed, would also result in cutting the state’s tax rate on long-term capital gains.

“The summary’s contrary statement is not a minor imprecision. It is significantly misleading and likely to influence voters,” Georges wrote for the court. “... The summary does not merely leave something unsaid. It affirmatively tells voters, in

INCOME TAX, Page A5

A TESTAMENT TO HOPE



JAMIE KELTER DAVIS/NEW YORK TIMES

Former president Barack Obama and Michelle Obama were joined by their daughters, Sasha and Malia, during the opening Thursday for the Obama Presidential Center in Chicago. “I hope this center will serve as an affirmation of just how special, how precious our democracy truly is and remind us what we can achieve when we embrace our shared responsibilities as citizens,” Obama said in his address. **A2.**

A celebration of freedom, marred by racist mob

In early 1800s, a white gang chased participants through Beacon Hill

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

In 1808, decades before the Emancipation Proclamation, Black Bostonians initiated an annual celebration of their own freedom granted by Massachusetts years earlier.

It wasn’t long after that one of those celebrations nearly erupted into a riot.

Massachusetts was the first state

to end to slavery, in 1783, and this angered some white citizens, according to historical records. They ridiculed the abolition day festivities, held every July 14, hissing and hooting as they followed the procession down the street.

One year, the holiday turned violent, as a white mob chased Black celebrants out of Boston Common and through the segregated streets

of Beacon Hill.

More than two centuries later, opposition to achievements by Black Americans continues. President Trump has rolled back numerous diversity, equity, and inclusion efforts depicting the struggles and accomplishments of Black Americans. His administration also removed Juneteenth, the June 19 federal holiday celebrating the national emancipation of slaves, from the calendar of fee-free days at all national parks, along with Martin Luther King Jr. Day, but added Trump’s birthday,

which is also Flag Day.

Meanwhile, a number of communities around the country canceled or scaled back Juneteenth celebrations last year because of funding cuts and safety concerns over rising racial tensions. But most of them continued, including in Boston, which marked the day with a flag-raising ceremony at City Hall Plaza and the State House on Thursday and will offer music Saturday at Franklin Park.

Juneteenth only became a federal
JUNETEENTH, Page A6

Life, liberty, and the pursuit of a rivalry

Boston as America’s ‘cradle’? No way, says Philly.

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

PHILADELPHIA — The stretch-run gallop here to the 250th anniversary of the country’s founding has featured an overflow smorgasbord of revolutionary commemorations, celebratory block parties, major sporting events, and a kaleidoscopic array of arts festivals.

For a visitor from Boston, the history-rich area around Independence Hall can feel like star-spangled, sensory overload. Philadelphia proclaims again and again in official statements that the city is “the birthplace of democracy.”

Boston, which like Philadelphia is currently packed with tens of thousands attending soccer’s World Cup, has its history, for sure. “It’s a lovely town,” one local historian said with a smirk. But most Philadelphians don’t feel that the Boston Tea Party and the battles of Lexington, Concord, and Bunker Hill outweigh what happened inside the red-brick walls of Independence Hall.

For Philadelphians, this rivalry is more than cheesesteaks versus chowder.

“The Revolution might have been started in
PHILADELPHIA, Page A7

Outdoor imbibing? We’ll drink to that.

Residents, officials in Cambridge embrace loosening of alcohol rules

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Most of the time, if I strolled up John F. Kennedy Street sipping a freshly poured draft beer out of a plastic cup, there would be trouble.

A bartender might chase me down to usher me back inside the restaurant or to the outdoor dining section.

Strangers, taking me for a misguided tourist, might politely remind you: *We don’t do that kind of thing around here.*

Not anymore. At least, not while the World Cup is in town.

Much to the surprise of locals, the city of Cambridge has begun allowing people to order cocktails, beer, and wine to-go, then enjoy them in so-called “open container districts” — huge swaths of its major squares — as long as the drinks are poured at a participating bar or restaurant.

Boston is now following suit, opening public drinking zones of its own starting Friday.

DRINKS, Page A7



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Cambridge requires an age verification wristband for people who order drinks to go. Boston is following suit.



Get a second wind

Friday: Breezy, some sun. High 81-86, low 62-67.

Saturday: See Friday.

High tide: 2:57, 3:41.

Sunrise: 5:07. Sunset: 8:24.

Weather and comics, **G6-7.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The percentage of Boston public high school graduates enrolling in college and continuing until graduation is rising, but wide gaps exist. B1.

The TD Garden rafters will get another number: The Bruins announced they are retiring the number of Patrice Bergeron. **C1.**

Hanscom Field in Bedford opened to commercial flights to Martha’s Vineyard and Nantucket. **B5.**

Ukraine launched its largest attack yet on Russia, bringing the war closer to civilians and businesses in and around Moscow. **A3.**

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